

CHALLENGE #13: Secrets Write-up.

Secrets

Medium

Web Exploitation

picoCTF 2022

AUTHOR: GEOFFREY NJOGU

Description

We have several pages hidden. Can you find the one with the flag?

Additional details will be available after launching your challenge instance.

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is:

NOT_RUNNING

Launch Instance

Hints

1

folders folders folders

29,628 users solved

76% Liked

picoCTF{FLAG}

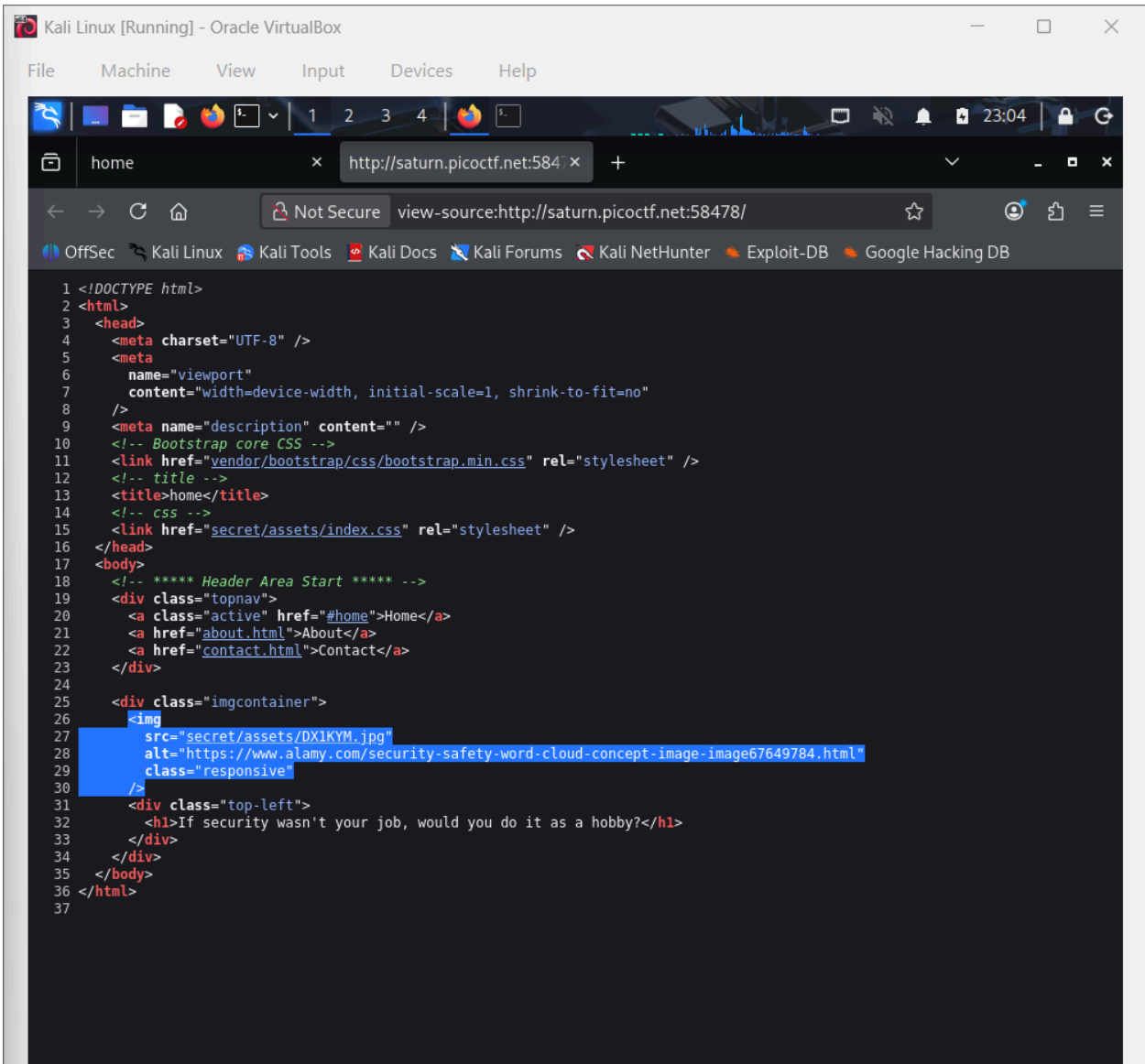
Submit Flag

Solving Process:

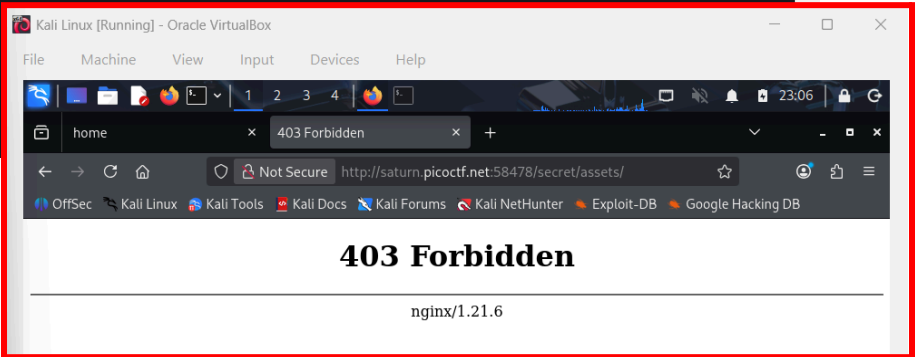
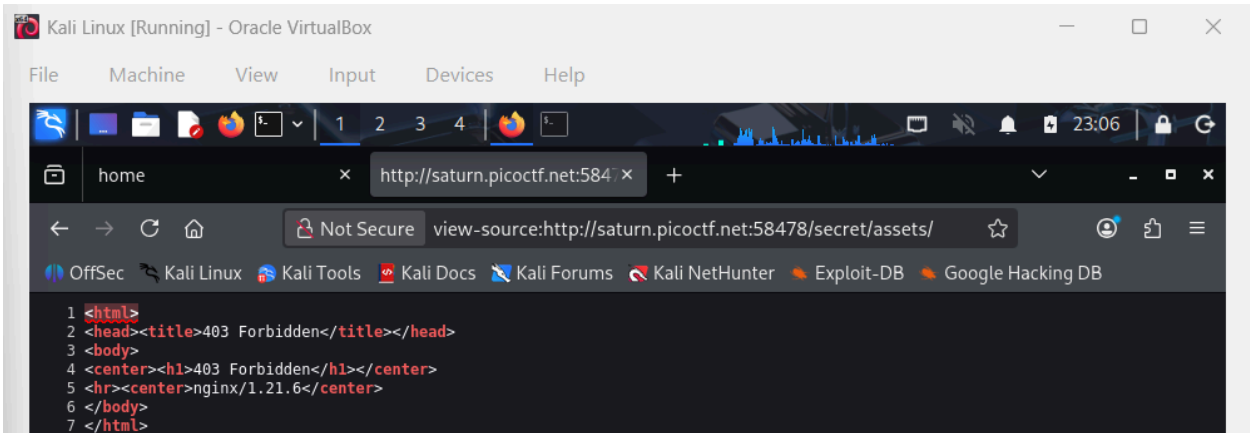


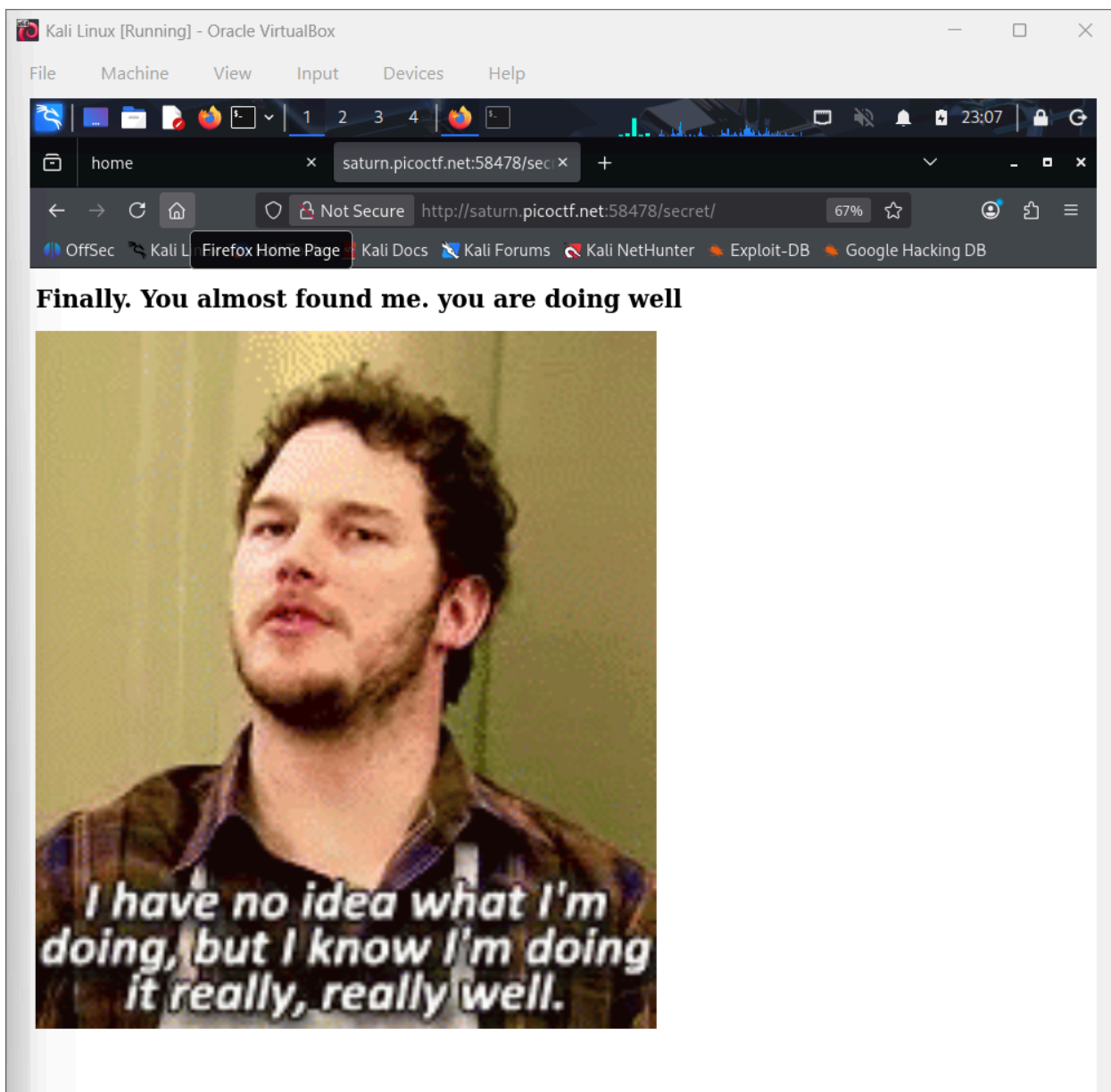
The website displayed a simple interface with three pages: **Home**, **About**, and **Contact**. According to the challenge description, there were **several hidden pages**, and the objective was to locate the one that contained the flag.

To begin investigating the website, the page source was viewed. While examining the HTML code, an **image tag** was noticed that referenced a file located within a directory named **secret**. This suggested that the website might contain hidden directories that were not directly linked through the navigation menu.

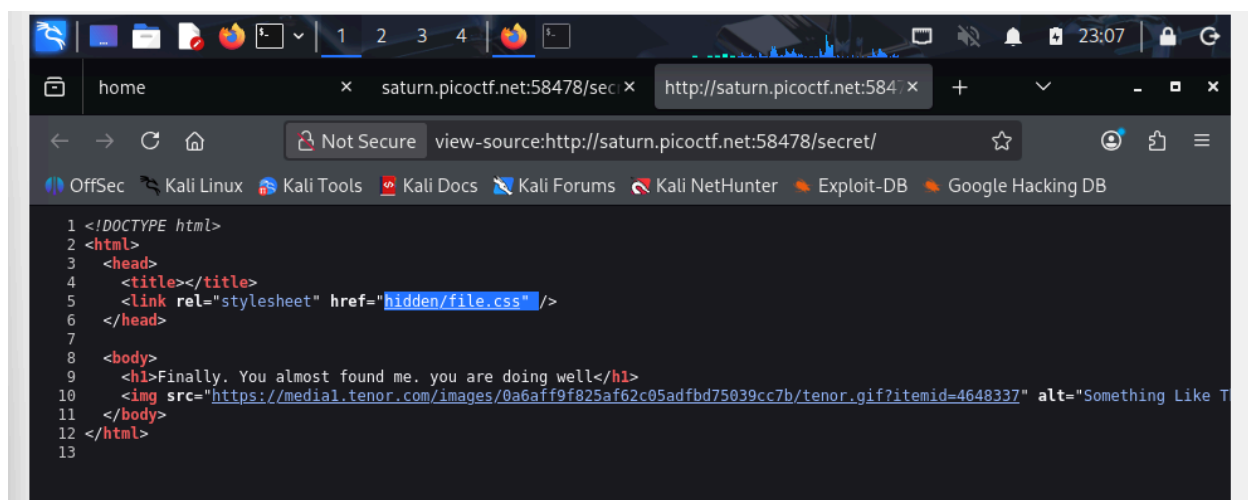


The image link was opened, which confirmed that the image was being loaded successfully from a path inside the assets directory under the **secret** folder. Attempting to directly access the assets directory resulted in a forbidden access message, indicating that directory listing was restricted. However, the secret directory itself could still be accessed.

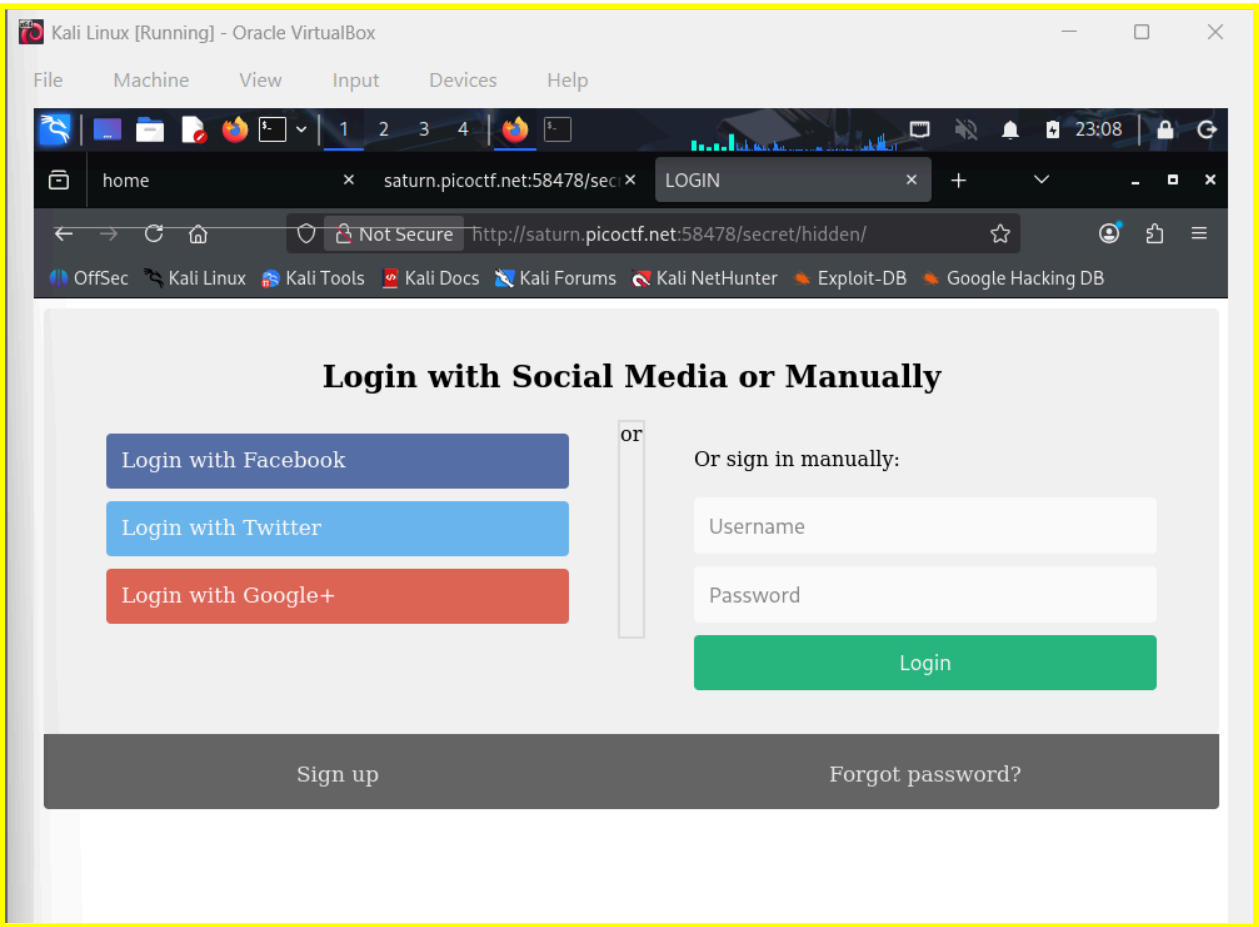
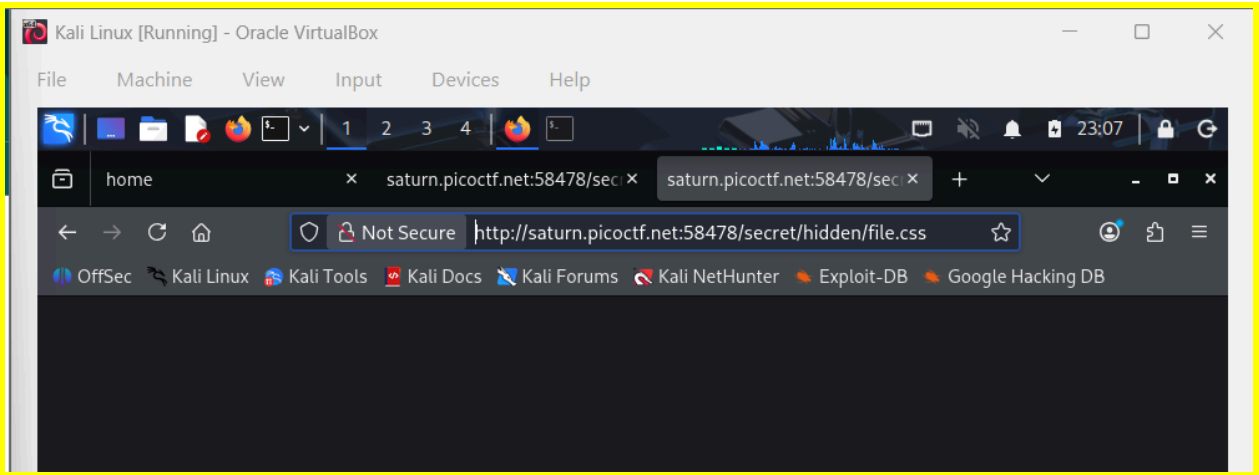




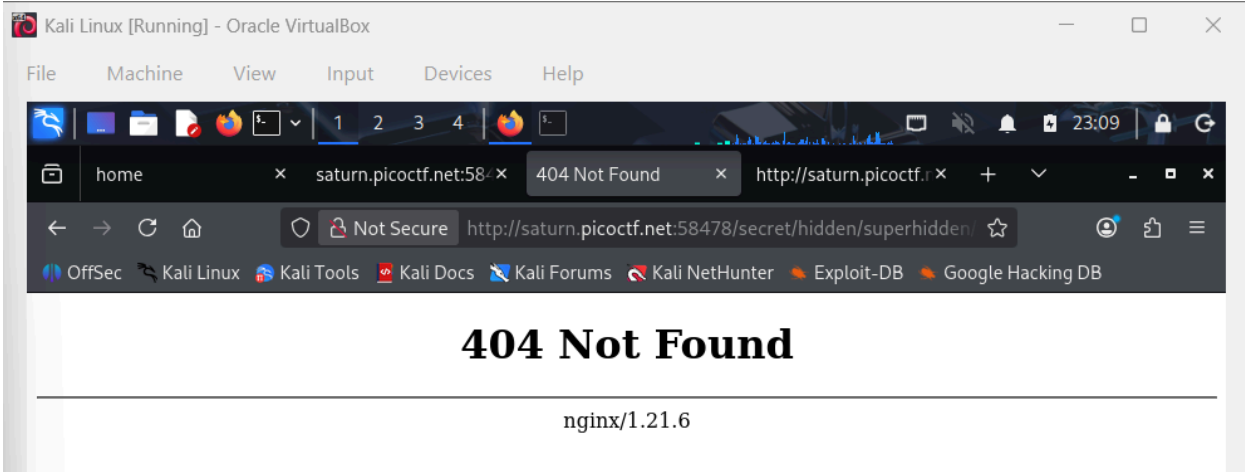
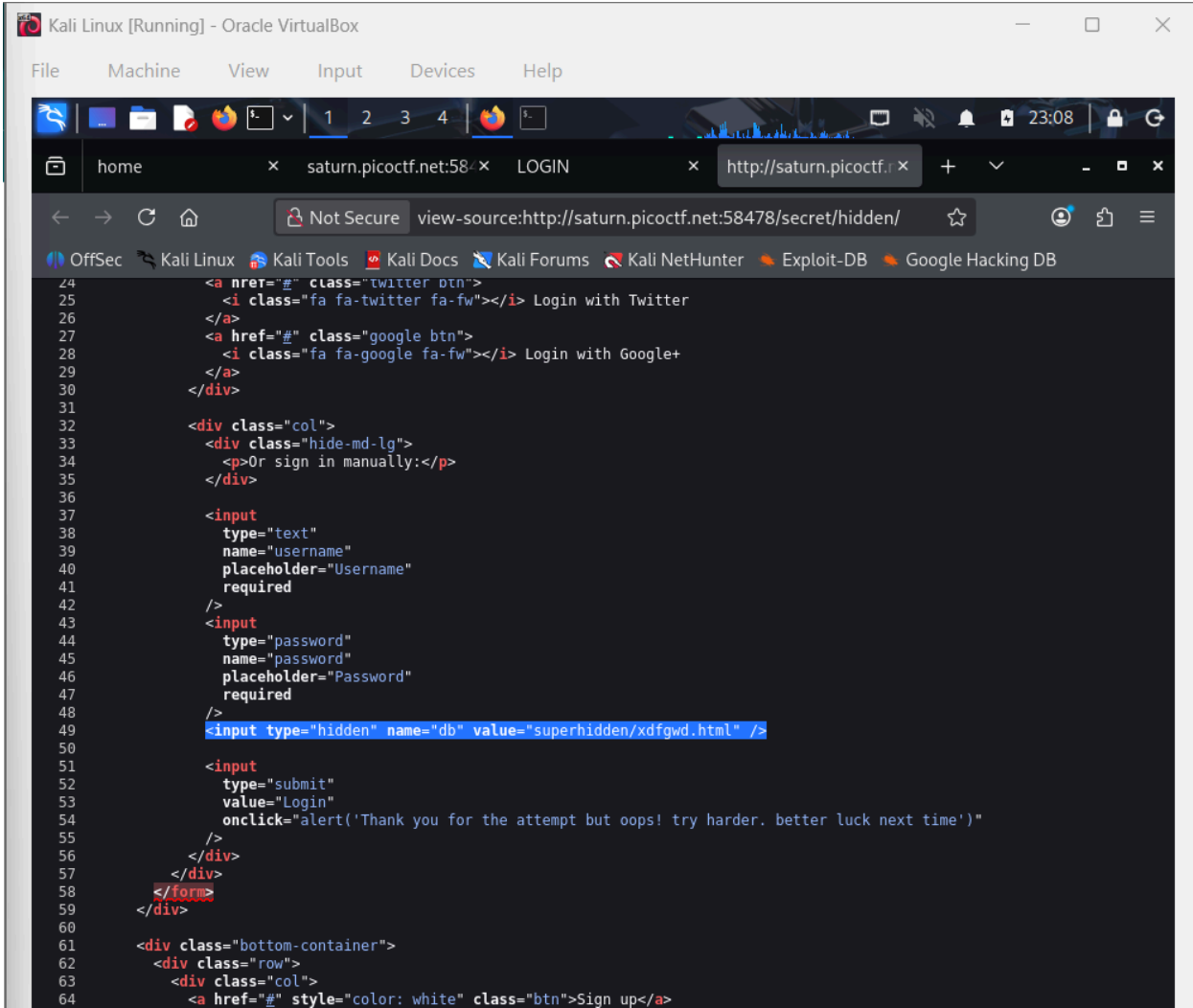
After navigating to the `/secret` directory, a new page appeared containing an image and a message that said **“You almost found me. You're doing well.”** To continue investigating, the source code of this page was examined. In the HTML code, a stylesheet reference was discovered that pointed to a CSS file located inside a directory called **hidden**.



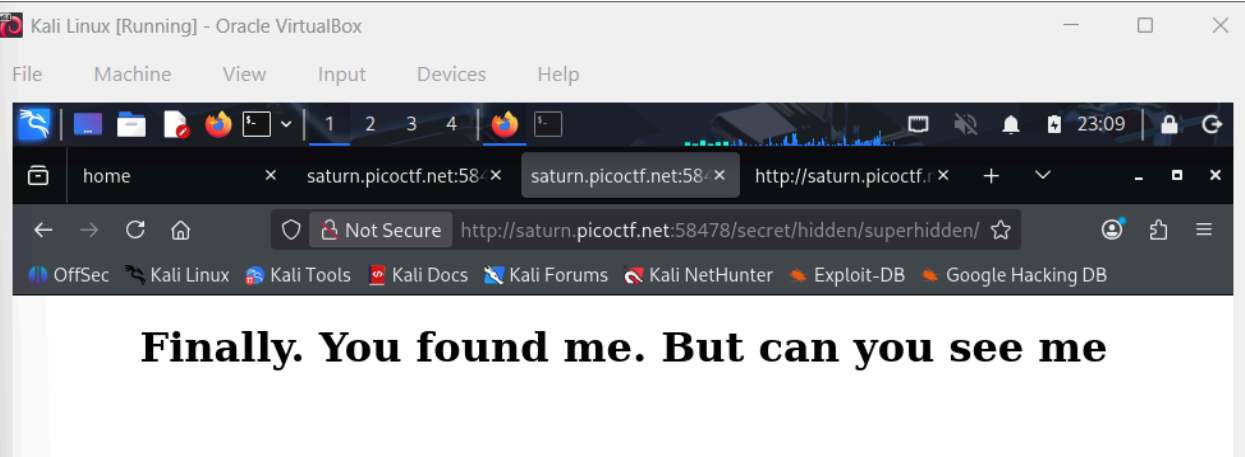
The path to this file was opened in the browser. Although the CSS file itself appeared empty, it revealed the existence of another directory named **/hidden**. Navigating directly to this directory led to a **login page**.

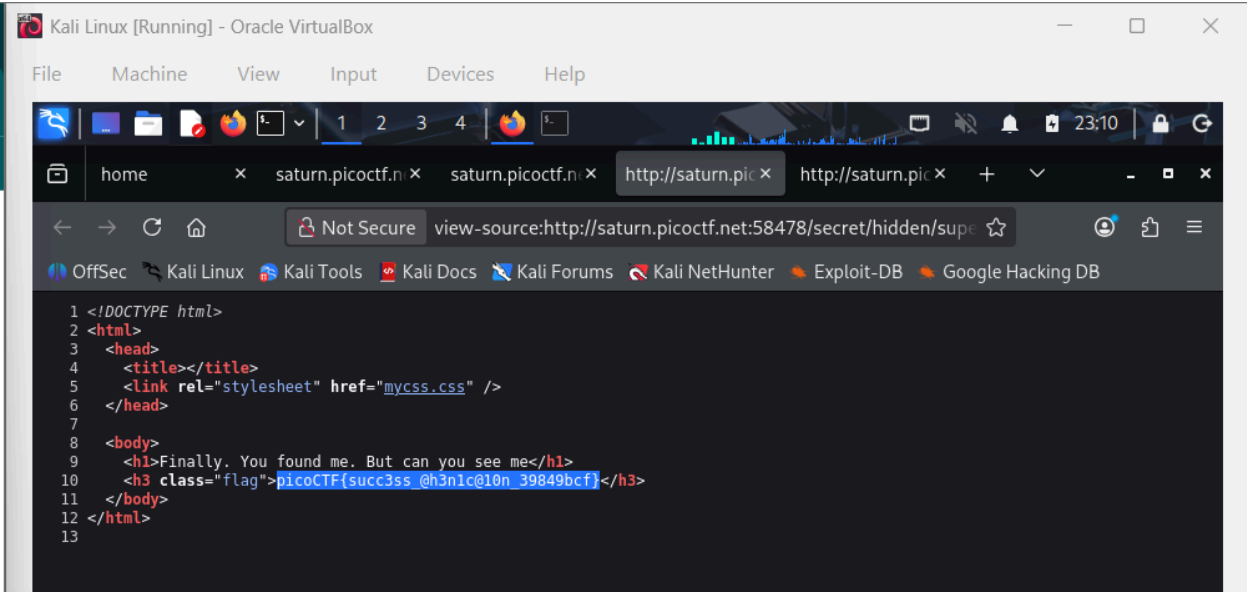


Once again, the source code of this new page was inspected. Within the login form, a **hidden input field** was discovered that referenced another path pointing to a directory called **superhidden**. Attempting to access the specific file mentioned in the source code resulted in a not found error, so the directory path itself was accessed instead.



After navigating to the **/superhidden** directory, a page appeared with the message “**Finally you found me but can you see me?**”. The source code of this page was then viewed, and within the HTML code the flag was revealed.





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Description

We have several pages hidden. Can you find the one with the flag?

The website is running [here](#).

This challenge launches an instance on demand.

Its current status is: **RUNNING**

Instance Time Remaining: **14:51**

Restart Instance

Hints

1

folders folders folders

29,628 users solved

76%

Liked

picoCTF{succ3ss_@h3n1c@10n_39849bcf}

Submit Flag

Hurray! You solved this challenge.

Reflection:

This challenge highlighted the importance of carefully examining website source code and directory structures when performing web security analysis. By following hidden paths referenced in the HTML files, it was possible to uncover multiple nested directories that were not visible in the main interface. The activity demonstrated how sensitive information can be unintentionally exposed through poorly hidden resources, emphasizing the need for proper access control and secure website configuration.